

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

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Report Name: GACC Announces New Storage and Transportation Requirements for Imported Bulk Edible Vegetable Oils

Country: China - People's Republic of

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Report Highlights:

On July 17, 2025, General Administration of Customs of China (GACC) announced new requirements for storing and transporting imported bulk edible vegetable oils and references the Codex Alimentarius Commission's "Code of Practice for the Storage and Transport of Edible Fats and Oils in Bulk" (CXC 36).

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On July 17, 2025, the General Administration of Customs of China (GACC) released the [Announcement on the Requirements for Storage and Transportation for Imported Bulk Edible Oil \(No. 147 of 2025\)](#). The stated purpose is to improve the supervision of the imported bulk edible oil supply chain, standardize and enhance storage and transportation management, and clarify the responsibility of food producers. GACC also published an accompanying set of [Frequently Asked Questions \(FAQs\)/Policy Interpretation](#) on the same day.

China reported cases of contamination of edible vegetable oil during transportation in May 2024, impacting several oilseed crushing companies. Several departments [including the State Council, National Development and Reform Commission, Ministry of Public Security, Ministry of Transport, National Health Commission, State Administration for Market Regulation (SAMR), and National Food and Strategic Reserves Administration] [conducted joint investigations](#) (link in Chinese) into the contamination issues. In April 2025, SAMR [released an action plan](#) for increasing inspections across the value chain.

In November 2024, China notified the WTO of a new national standard for Hygienic Requirements for the Bulk Transportation of Edible Vegetable Oils under [G/TBT/N/CHN/1943](#). SAMR released the final mandatory national standard [GB 44917-2024](#) (link in Chinese) in November 2024. The standard entered into force on February 1, 2025, regulating the sanitary requirements for loading, unloading, records management, and transportation for bulk edible vegetable oils in China.

Below is a machine translation of GACC Announcement No. 147 of 2025. A translation of the accompanying FAQs immediately follows.

BEGIN TRANSLATION

General Administration of Customs Announcement No. 147 of 2025 (Announcement on the Storage and Transportation Requirements for Imported Bulk Edible Vegetable Oils)

Since the implementation of the "Hygiene Requirements for the Bulk Transport of Edible Vegetable Oils" (GB 44917) standard in February 2025, the majority of edible vegetable oil import and export companies have conscientiously implemented the relevant requirements, effectively ensuring the quality and safety of imported bulk edible vegetable oils. To further strengthen the full-chain supervision of imported edible vegetable oils, standardize and strengthen the storage and transportation management of imported bulk edible vegetable oils, and consolidate the main responsibilities of food production and operation companies, in accordance with the "Customs Law of the People's Republic of China", "Food Safety Law of the People's Republic of China" and other laws and regulations, and with reference to the Codex Alimentarius Commission's "Code of Practice for the Storage and Transport of Edible Fats and Oils in Bulk" (CXC 36), the following requirements for the storage, transportation, and port declaration of imported bulk edible vegetable oils are hereby emphasized and clarified:

1. Oil storage tanks and transportation containers for imported bulk edible vegetable oil should be made of inert materials that do not react with edible vegetable oil and are suitable for contact with food, and stainless-steel materials are the most suitable. It is prohibited to use copper and its alloy storage tanks to ship imported bulk edible vegetable oil.
2. Imported bulk edible vegetable oil international transportation storage tanks and containers should be kept clean and hygienic, and regular cleaning and maintenance inspections should be carried out. The materials of oil pipelines, pipe fittings, valves, sealing parts, heating coils and other materials attached to oil storage tanks and transportation containers shall comply with the requirements of the "Operational Regulations for the Storage and Transportation of Bulk Edible Grease" (CXC36).
3. If imported bulk edible vegetable oil is transported in disposable containers such as flexitanks, the disposable containers shall be made of clean, non-toxic, safe, and direct food contact materials, and shall be used once within the validity period (shelf life) and shall not be reused.
4. Importers, exporters or agents of imported bulk edible vegetable oil shall supervise international transport carriers to comply with the requirements of the Operational Regulations for the Storage and Transportation of Bulk Edible Oils and Oils (CXC36). The goods transported by the oil tank (warehouse) loaded with edible vegetable oil must be food or items listed in the "List of Acceptable Transported Goods of the Codex Alimentarius" (Annex 1), and the oil tank (warehouse) that has previously been loaded with the items listed in the List of Recently Transported Goods Prohibited by the Codex Alimentarius (Annex 2) shall not be used for transportation. For imported bulk edible vegetable oil transported in non-disposable containers, domestic importers or agents are required to provide a list of goods transported at least the first three voyages of the means of transport when declaring imports.
5. If the imported bulk edible vegetable oil is transported from the port to the destination and needs to change the means of transport or container, or is imported after circulation in special customs supervision areas, bonded supervision places, and production and processing, it shall

be transported by a domestic carrier with corresponding qualifications using special means of transport or containers that meet the requirements of the "Hygienic Requirements for Bulk Transportation of Edible Vegetable Oil" (GB 44917).

This announcement shall take effect from the date of issuance. The former Announcement No. 80 of 2012 of the General Administration of Quality Supervision, Inspection and Quarantine (Announcement on the Requirements for Imported Bulk Edible Vegetable Oil Transportation Vehicles) shall be repealed at the same time.

END TRANSLATION

BEGIN TRANSLATION

Policy Interpretation of the Announcement on the Storage and Transportation Requirements for Imported Bulk Edible Vegetable Oil

Since the implementation of the "Hygiene Requirements for the Bulk Transport of Edible Vegetable Oils" (GB 44917) on February 1, 2025, numerous edible vegetable oil import and export companies have diligently implemented the relevant requirements, effectively ensuring the quality and safety of imported bulk edible vegetable oils. To further strengthen the full-chain supervision of imported edible vegetable oils, clarify requirements for the materials, cleaning, and maintenance of transportation vehicles and containers, standardize and strengthen the management of the storage and transportation of imported bulk edible vegetable oils, and strengthen the primary responsibility of food production and distribution companies, the General Administration of Customs has issued the "Announcement on Relevant Requirements for the Storage and Transportation of Imported Bulk Edible Vegetable Oils" (hereinafter referred to as the "Announcement"), which emphasizes and clarifies the requirements for the storage, transportation, and port declaration of imported bulk edible vegetable oils. An interpretation of the Announcement is provided below.

1. What are the requirements for transport containers for imported bulk edible vegetable oil in the announcement?

The announcement clarifies that storage tanks and transport containers for imported bulk edible vegetable oils must be made of inert materials (stainless steel is most suitable) that do not react with the oil and are suitable for food contact. The use of copper and its alloys is prohibited to prevent metal ion migration and oil contamination. Storage tanks and transport containers must be kept clean and sanitary and undergo regular maintenance and inspection. The materials used for pipelines, fittings, valves, seals, heating coils, and other components of storage tanks and transport containers must comply with the "Operational Procedures for the Storage and Transportation of Bulk Edible Oils and Fats" (CXC36-2024). When transporting imported bulk edible vegetable oils in disposable containers, such as flexitank containers, these containers must be made of clean, non-toxic, harmless materials suitable for direct food contact. They must be used once within their expiration date (shelf life) and not reused.

2. What are the requirements for the previous shipment of imported bulk edible vegetable oil transport containers and import declarations in the announcement?

Based on CXC36-2024, the announcement updates the "List of Acceptable Previous Cargoes" and the "List of Recently Prohibited Goods" under the Food Codex Alimentarius. It also clarifies that edible vegetable oils must have been previously transported in tanks or warehouses containing food or items listed on the "List of Acceptable Previous Cargoes" under the Food Codex Alimentarius. Tanks or warehouses that have previously carried items listed on the "List of Recently Prohibited Goods" under the Food Codex Alimentarius may not be used for transportation. For imported bulk edible vegetable oils transported in non-disposable containers, domestic importers or agents must provide a list of the cargo carried

on at least three previous voyages of the transport vehicle when submitting import declarations.

3. What are the requirements of the announcement for the transportation process of imported bulk edible vegetable oil from the import port to the destination?

The announcement clearly states that imported bulk edible vegetable oil must comply with the requirements of GB44917-2024 when transporting it from the port to the destination. The carrier must obtain the corresponding transportation qualifications and use special transportation vehicles and containers for transportation.

4. What should importers pay attention to after the announcement is officially released and implemented?

- a. Importers should establish an audit system for overseas exporters and overseas production enterprises, and manage the entire supply chain of imported edible vegetable oils;
- b. Importers need to supervise international transport carriers to comply with CXC36-2024 and ensure compliance with the entire process from loading to delivery;
- c. Seriously implement the import and sales record system for imported edible vegetable oils, and supervise the carriers to establish and improve the use, cleaning, and maintenance records of transport containers to achieve traceable management.

(Produced by: Import and Export Food Safety Bureau, Nanjing Customs)

END TRANSLATION

Attachments:

No Attachments.